



Migration, Labor, and the Global Economy

NAME

DATE

LEARNING OUTCOMES — CHECK EACH ONE OFF AS YOU MASTER IT

Explain migrant labor contributions to economies

Describe remittances and their impacts

Identify sectors relying on migrant labor and recognize exploitation risks

Discuss challenges faced by migrant workers

KEY TERMS — DEFINE EACH IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Remittances

Debt bondage

Kafala system

Labor migration



GUIDED NOTES — FILL IN THE MISSING FIGURES AS YOU FOLLOW THE LECTURE

1. According to the ILO's 2022 Global Estimates, approximately _____ international migrant workers exist globally — roughly 4.9 percent of the total labor force worldwide.

2. Men account for approximately _____ of migrant workers globally, but women are overrepresented in sectors like domestic work and care, where labor protections are weakest.

3. The average global cost of sending USD 200 in remittances was approximately _____ in Q1 2024 (World Bank Remittance Prices Worldwide), still far above the SDG target of 3 percent by 2030.

REFLECTION — ANSWER IN FULL SENTENCES

A wealthy country has a structural shortage of care workers. It recruits nurses from a country that also faces a nursing shortage. What ethical obligations does the recruiting country have, and to whom?

Is the kafala system fundamentally incompatible with international human rights standards, or can it be reformed? What would genuine reform look like — and what political obstacles prevent it?

MY QUESTIONS FOR CLASS